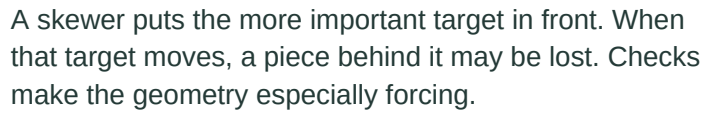


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and queen on b8. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28.Rg8+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From g8 it attacks king on e8 and rook on h8. Recorded reply: **28...Ke7**.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -4 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.